UNIT 4: STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESS

PART I: JOB READINESS

TOPIC 2: WORKPLACE SAFETY

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand workplace hazards and some things he/she can do to stay safe at work
- Better understand workplace safety laws, child labor laws and her/his rights on the job

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Identify potential hazards in various workplace settings
- Know where to go to find more information about his/her rights and workplace safety information

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Safety IQ Quiz

From http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/ retrieved April 16, 2010

Hand out the "Safety IQ Quiz" and ask students to answer the questions. Review the correct answers with all participants:

Quiz Answers

1. True You should get training before you start work. The training should cover how to do your job safely. Training about hazardous chemicals and other health and safety hazards at your job is required by OSHA (the Occupational and Safety Health Administration), the agency that enforces workplace health and safety laws.

2. True The federal law says if you are 14 or 15, you can only work until 7pm on a school night. Some states also have restrictions on how late you can work if you are 16 or 17. Child labor laws protect teens from working too late, too early or too long.

3. False Teens who are 16 may not drive a car or truck on public streets as part of their jobs. Federal law permits teens who are 17 to drive in very limited situations. Some states do not allow anyone under 18 to drive on the job. Child labor laws protect teens from doing dangerous work.

4. True If you get hurt on the job, the law says your employer must provide worker's compensation benefits. These include medical care for your injury.

5. One every 7 minutes Overall, 84,000 teens are hurt each year badly enough to go to a hospital emergency room. Only one-third of work-related injuries are seen in emergency rooms, so it is likely that 250,000 teens suffer work-related injuries each year. This number is fairly close to the number of teens (ages 15-17) who go to emergency rooms each year for all motor vehicle accidents, including vehicle occupants, pedestrians, bicyclists, and motorcyclists (320, 000 teens). About 64 teens (17 and under) die each year from job injuries. About 90 who are 18 or 19 die. Teens are often injured on the job due to unsafe equipment or stressful conditions. They also may not receive enough safety training or supervision.

Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will understand what workplace hazards are and the main categories of hazards on the job.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handouts: "Workplace Scenes," pens/pencils

Explain that one reason workers get hurt on the job is because there are hazards (dangers) on the job. A job hazard is anything at work that can hurt you either physically or mentally. (http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/)

There are three main categories of hazards — safety hazards, chemical hazards, and biological hazards, but those categories do not cover all job hazards. Ask students if they can think of examples of safety hazards? Chemical hazards? Biological hazards? Other health hazards? (Some examples are included below.)

- Safety hazards: knives, hot grease, hot surfaces, slippery floors, etc.
- Chemical hazards: dusts, gases, vapors, acids, asbestos, lead, etc.
- Biological hazards: living organisms, viruses, molds, used needles, etc
- Other health hazards: noise, radiation, repetitive movements, heat or cold, stress, harassment

Hunting for Hazards (http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/)

Divide the students into four small groups. Give each group one of the workplace scenes, with enough copies for each member of the group. Have them identify as many hazards in the picture as they can, as well as offer suggestions to address the safety concern.

Examples:

- Fast food: hot grill, fire, cooking grease, heavy lifting, cleaning chemicals, stress, steam, hot oven, knives, slippery floor, pressure to work fast
- Grocery Store: heavy lifting, meat slicer, repetitive motion, standing a lot, box cutter, cleaning chemicals, bending or reaching, stress
- Office: repetitive use of the keyboard, awkward posture, stress, cluttered workplace, copier and other chemicals
- Gas station: gasoline, heat or cold, stress, other chemicals, tools and equipment, violence

Ways to deal with hazards at work:

- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)
- Work Policies/Practices
- Remove the Hazard (not always possible)

Workplace Safety/MA Child Labor Laws Scavenger Hunt

Objective: Students will discover where they can go to find out about workplace safety and MA child labor laws.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handout: "Workplace Safety/MA Child Labor Laws Scavenger Hunt," computers with Internet access, small prizes (optional)

Divide the students into groups of 2-3 (or one group per available computer). Hand out one scavenger hunt to each student and one extra for each group. Explain that they will have ten minutes to complete the scavenger hunt and put all of their answers on the group sheet. Groups can work together or split up the work. After ten minutes, collect the group sheets and if you choose to, award prizes to the winning group.

Discuss the correct answers and where people went to find the information.

Answers:

1. How many hours per week can a 14 year old work while school is in session? **18**
2. What is the maximum number of hours a 15 year old can work on a school day? **3**
3. What is the maximum number of hours a 16 year old can work in one day? **9**
4. What is the maximum number of days a 17 year old can work in a week? **6**
5. What is the latest that a 14 year old can work on a school day? **7 pm**
   In the summer? **9 pm**
6. How old do you have to be to work in a freezer or meat cooler? **at least 16**
7. How old do you have to be to operate, clean or repair power-driven bakery machines? **at least 18**
8. How old do you have to be to work on ladders or scaffolds? **at least 16 (if more than 30 ft above ground or water the answer is at least 18)**
9. How old do you have to be to work in amusement places (such as a pool or billiard room or bowling alley)? **at least 16**
10. How old do you have to be to work in roofing or on or about a roof? **at least 18**
11. What is minimum wage in Mass? **$8.00/hr**
12. How many hours do you have to work in a week to qualify for overtime pay? **Over 40**
13. What does Worker's Compensation pay for? **Medical expenses and lost wages**
14. What is the name of the agency that handles complaints about workplace safety? **OSHA**
15. What is one health and safety protection your employer must provide? **Safety training, PPE (personal protective equipment)**

Reading/Resource to take home: Handout: "Are You a Working Teen? Protect Your Health! Know Your Rights!"

Federal and State labor laws:

- Set a minimum age for some types of dangerous work
- Protect teens from working too long, too late or too early

OSHA says every employer must provide:

- A safe and healthy workplaces
- Safety training on certain hazards, including information on dangerous chemicals
- Safety equipment

By law, your employer is not allowed to fire or punish you for reporting a safety problem.

Your Safety IQ Quiz

Work together in your group to answer these questions. Guessing is OK. You won't be graded on your answers. Pick one person in your group to report your answers to the class later.

✔ **Check the correct answer.**

1. The law says your employer must give you training about health and safety hazards on your job.

❑ True ❑ False ❑ Don't know

2. The law sets limits on how late you may work on a school night if you are under 16.

❑ True ❑ False ❑ Don't know

3. If you are 16 years old, you are allowed to drive a car on public streets as part of your job.

❑ True ❑ False ❑ Don't know

4. If you're injured on the job, your employer must pay for your medical care.

❑ True ❑ False ❑ Don't know

5. How many teens get seriously injured on the job in the U.S.?

❑ One per day ❑ One per hour ❑ One every 7 minutes ❑ Don't know

http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/



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Worker Safety/MA Child Labor Laws Scavenger Hunt

1. **How many hours per week can a 14 yr old work while school is in session?**

2. **What is the maximum number of hours a 15 yr old can work on a school day?**

3. **What is the maximum number of hours a 16 yr old can work in one day?**

4. **What is the maximum number of days a 17 yr old can work in a week?**

5. **What is the latest that a 14 yr old can work on a school day? In the summer?**

6. **How old do you have to be to work in a freezer or meat cooler?**

7. **How old do you have to be to operate, clean or repair power-driven bakery machines?**

8. **How old do you have to be to work on ladders or scaffolds?**

9. **How old do you have to be to work in amusement places (such as a pool or billiard room or bowling alley)?**

10. **How old do you have to be to work in roofing or on or about a roof?**

11. **What is minimum wage in Massachusetts?**

12. **How many hours do you have to work in a week to qualify for overtime pay?**

13. **What does Worker's Compensation pay for?**

14. **What is the name of the agency that handles complaints about workplace safety?**

15. **What is one health and safety protection your employer must provide?**

Sources used:

Protect Your Health! Know Your Rights!







Could I Get Hurt or Sick on the Job?

- 18-year-old Sylvia caught her hand in an electric cabbage shredder at a fast food restaurant. Her hand is permanently disfigured and she'll never have full use of it again.
- 17-year-old Joe lost his life while working as a construction helper. An electric shock killed him when he climbed a metal ladder to hand an electric drill to another worker.
- 16-year-old Donna was assaulted and robbed at gunpoint at a sandwich shop. She was working alone after 11 p.m.

Every year nearly **70 teens under 18 die** from work injuries in the United States. Another **84,000 get hurt** badly enough that they go to a hospital emergency room.

Why do injuries like these occur? Teens are often injured on the job due to unsafe equipment, stressful conditions, and speed-up. Also they may not receive adequate safety training and supervision.

Teens are much more likely to be injured when they work on jobs they are not allowed to do by law.

What Hazards Should I Watch Out For?

Type of Work	Examples of Hazards
Janitor/Clean-up	• Toxic chemicals in cleaning products • Blood on discarded needles
Food Service	• Slippery floors • Hot cooking equipment • Sharp objects
Retail/Sales	• Violent crimes • Heavy lifting
Office/Clerical	• Stress • Harassment • Poor computer work station design

http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/

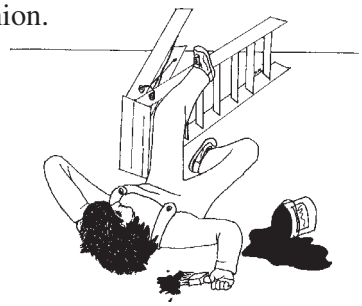
What Are My Rights on the Job?

By law, your employer must provide:

- A safe and healthful workplace.
- Training on chemicals and other health and safety hazards.
- Protective clothing and equipment.
- In most cases, at least the Massachusetts minimum wage of $6.75 an hour.
- 1/2 hour meal period after no more than 6 hours
- Workers' compensation benefits if you are hurt on the job. These include:
  - Medical care for your injury, whether or not you miss time from work.
  - Payments if you lose wages for more than 5 calendar days.
  - Other benefits if you become permanently disabled.

You also have a right to:

- Report safety problems to OSHA.
- Work without racial or sexual harassment.
- Refuse to work if the job is immediately dangerous to your life or health.
- Join or organize a union.



Is It OK to Do Any Kind of Work?

NO! There are laws that protect teens from doing dangerous work.

In Massachusetts no worker under 18 may:

- Drive a motor vehicle on public streets as part of the job (17-year-olds may drive in very limited circumstances)
- Drive a forklift or other heavy equipment
- Use powered equipment like a circular saw, box crusher, meat slicer, or bakery machine
- Work in wrecking, demolition, excavation, or roofing
- Work in logging or a sawmill
- Prepare, serve, or sell alcoholic beverages
- Work where there is exposure to radiation or toxic substances

***Also,* no one 14 or 15 years old may:**

- Do any baking activities
- Cook (except with electric or gas grills that do not involve cooking over an open flame and with deep fat fryers that automatically lower and raise the baskets)
- Work in dry cleaning or a commercial laundry
- Do building, construction, or manufacturing work
- Load or unload a truck, railroad car, or conveyor
- Work on a ladder or scaffold

http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/

Are There Other Things I Can't Do?

YES! There are other restrictions on the type of work you can and cannot do. **Age 14** is the minimum for most employment, except for informal jobs like babysitting or yard work. Check with your state labor department, school counselor, or job placement coordinator to make sure the job you are doing is allowed.

Do I Need Working Papers?

YES! If you are under 18 and plan to work, you must get a *work permit* (if you are 14 or 15) or an *educational certificate* (if you are 16 or 17). Check with your school department or visit *www.mass.gov/dos/youth*



What Are My Safety Responsibilities on the Job?

To work safely you should:

- Follow all safety rules and instructions; use safety equipment and protective clothing when needed
- Look out for co-workers
- Keep work areas clean and neat
- Know what to do in an emergency
- Report any health and safety hazard to your supervisor
- Ask questions if you don't understand

Should I Be Working This Late or This Long?

Child labor laws protect teens from working too long, too late, or too early.

This table shows the hours teens may work. (Some school districts may have more restrictive regulations. Also, there are some exceptions for teens in work experience education programs.)

Work Hours for Teens

	Ages 14 and 15	Ages 16 and 17
Work Hours	• 7 am–7 pm, from Labor Day–July 1 • Not during school hours • 7 am–9 pm, from July 1–Labor Day	• 6 am–10 pm when there is school the next day • 6 am–12 am if you work in a restaurant or at a racetrack and there is no school the next day
Maximum Hours When School Is in Session	18 hours a week, but not over: • 3 hours a day on school days • 8 hours a day Saturday–Sunday and holidays • 6 days a week	48 hours a week, but not over: • 9 hours a day • 6 days a week
Maximum Hours When School Is *not* in Session	40 hours a week, but not over: • 8 hours a day • 6 days a week	48 hours a week, but not over: • 9 hours a day • 6 days a week



http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/

What If I Get Hurt on the Job?

- Tell your supervisor right away. If you're under 18, tell your parents or guardians too.
- Get emergency medical treatment if needed.
- Your employer must give you a **claim form**. Fill it out and return it to your employer. This helps ensure that you receive workers' compensation benefits.

Workers' Compensation: Did You Know?

- You can receive benefits:
  - Even if you are under 18.
  - Even if you are a temporary or part-time worker (in most cases).
- You receive benefits no matter who was at fault for your job injury.
- You don't have to be a legal resident of the U.S. to receive benefits.
- You can't sue your employer for a job injury (in most cases).

You have a *right* to speak up!

It is illegal for your employer to fire or punish you for reporting a workplace problem or injury, or for claiming workers' compensation.

The information in this factsheet reflects your state and/or federal labor laws, whichever are more protective. The more protective laws usually apply. Check with your state agencies listed at the right.

What If I Have a Safety Problem?

- Talk to your supervisor, parents, teachers, job training representative, or union representative (if any) about the problem.
- If necessary contact one of these agencies.

For health and safety information and advice:

- National Young Worker Safety Resource Center (many materials available in Spanish)
  ☎ (510) 643-2424 *www.youngworkers.org*
- Mass. Dept. of Public Health, Occupational Health Surveillance Program
  ☎ (617) 624-5632
  www.mass.gov/dph/bhsre/ohsp/ohsp.htm

To make a health or safety complaint:

- OSHA (Occupational Safety and Health)
  ☎ (800) 321-OSHA (6742)
  www.osha.gov

To make a complaint about wages or work hours:

- Office of Mass. Attorney General
  Fair Labor & Business Practices Division
  ☎ (617) 727-3465 *www.ago.state.ma.us*
- US. Department of Labor
  ☎ (866) 487-9243 (617) 624-6700
  www.wagehour.dol.gov

To make a complaint about sexual harassment or discrimination:

- Mass. Commission Against Discrimination
  ☎ (617) 994-6000 *www.mass.gov/mcad*
- US Equal Employment Opportunity Commission
  ☎ (800) 669-4000 *www.youth.eeoc.gov*

For information about benefits for injured workers:

- Mass. Dept. of Industrial Accidents
  ☎ (800) 323-3249
  www.mass.gov/dia

http://www.cdc.gov/niosh/talkingsafety/states/ma/